

THE MYSTERIOUS PEACOCK

A Classic Brazilian Cordel Translated into English

I shall sing you a story now
Of a modern and rare invention
That caused a mighty sensation
And made many a scholar bow
A peacock that learned to fly
Far across the windy sky.

An engineer of great renown
Built this bird of steel and art
With a highly complex heart
Deep inside a distant town
It could soar and it could glide
With a lucky man inside.

A young man named Evangelista
Saw the bird and bought it whole
With a wild spark in his soul
Like a true romanticista
He flew away to find his fate
And knock upon a secret gate.

In a kingdom far away
Lived a maiden named Creusa
A beautiful and silent musa
Locked inside both night and day
By a father strict and cold
Guarding her like heavy gold.

Through the window of her tower
Evangelista flew right in
With a soft and gentle grin
In the midnight's quiet hour
The mechanical peacock gleamed
Just as if they both had dreamed.

"Do not fear, my lovely maid,
I have come to set you free
Fly across the world with me
In this bird that I have made"
She agreed without delay
And together they flew away.

Though the king sent men to chase
Through the valley and the plain
All their efforts were in vain
As the lovers kept their pace
Safe inside their metal prize
Sailing through the open skies.